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Exercises for Morphology

The Internal Structure of Words and Processes of Word Formation in English

1. ***Analyze the following words into morphs using the model given below.***

	Prefix(es)	*Root*	*Suffix(es)*
inequality	in-	equal	-ity

(a) hospitalization
(b) invisibly
(c) uninteresting
(d) undercooked
(e) transcontinental
(f) ungrammatical
(g) reinforcement
(h) prototypical
(i) unforgettable
(j) impropriety
(k) disfunctional
(l) inconsiderate
(m) postcolonial
(n) unlikelihood
(o) relationship
(p) asymmetrical
(q) hypersensitivity
(r) unfriendliness
(s) interdependence
(t) monotheism

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2. ***For each of the bold words in the passage from Wallace Stegner's "The Dump Ground" below, label the inflectional suffix:***

pres	= present tense	compr	= comparative degree
past	= past tense	supl	= superlative degree
prsprt	= present participle	poss	= possessive case
pstprt	= past participle	pl	= plural number

The place fascinated us, as it **should** have. For this was the kitchen midden of all the civilization we knew. It gave us the **most** tantalizing glimpses into our **neighbors'** lives and our own; it provided an aesthetic distance from which to know **ourselves**.

The town dump was our poetry and our history. We **took** it home with us by the wagonload, **bringing** back into town the things the town had **used** and thrown away. Some little part of what we **gathered**, mainly bottles, we managed to bring back to usefulness, but most of our gleanings we left **lying** around barn or attic or cellar until in some **renewed** fury of spring cleanup our **families** carted them off to the dump again, to be rescued and briefly treasured by some other boy. Occasionally something we really valued with a passion was snatched from us in horror and **returned** at once. That happened to the mounted head of a white mountain goat, **somebody's** trophy from old times and the far Rocky Mountains, that I

brought home one day. My mother took one look and discovered that his beard was full of moths.

I **remember** that goat; I regret him yet. Poetry is seldom useful, but always memorable. If I were a sociologist anxious to study in detail the life of any community I **would** go very early to **its** refuse piles. For a community may be as well **judged** by what it throws away - what it has to throw away and what it **chooses** to - as by any other evidence. For whole civilizations we sometimes have no **more** of the poetry and little more of the history than this (from *Wolf Willow* 1955: 35-36).

3. Divide the following words into morphs (use slashes) and then list the morphemes. Note that some words may require more than one analysis into morphemes.

Example: mice's

Answer: mice/s; {mouse} + {pl} + {poss}

(a)	least	(k)	our
(b)	set	(l)	rings
(c)	fish	(m)	sayings
(d)	should	(n)	broken
(e)	hoped	(o)	these
(f)	hearing	(p)	whose
(g)	were	(q)	older
(h)	elder	(r)	her
(i)	must	(s)	taken
(j)	topmost	(t)	women's

4. Sort the prefixes in the words below into the following seven categories according to meaning:

a. Time
b. Number
c. Place
d. Degree
e. Privative
f. Negative
g. Size

postdate	maladjusted
bifocal	Outdoor
megawatt	Defrost
disclose	foreshadow
polygon	Bisexual
subway	Disarm
ultraconservative	hyperthyroidism

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5. Sort the suffixes in the words below according to their class-changing function. The categories include the following. There are two examples of each suffix.

a. N > N
b. V > N
c. A > N
d. N/A > V
e. N > A
f. V > A
g. N/A > Adv

broaden	syntactic	width	Idealism
participant	falsehood	closure	Straighten
rhetorician	clockwise	refusal	Vaccinate
gangster	stardom	warmth	Tireless
twofold	trial	accidental	Selfish
advisory	likelihood	friendless	Politician
conservatism	mobster	kingdom	Facilitate
inhabitant	contradictory	boyish	Seizure
manifold	stepwise	thankless	Global
historic	penniless		

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6. Identify the syntactic pattern in each of the following compounds and express it in a lexical rule.

Example: gravedigger N + V + -er > N

a. hovercraft
b. dairyman
c. bath-towel
d. goldfish
e. inroads
f. bystander
g. setback
h. meltdown
i. blackout
j. stand-in
k. turnout
l. money-hungry
m. dugout
n. hardhearted
o. homesick
p. proofread
q. overqualified
r. overachieve
s. badmouth
t. redhead
u. birth control
v. breakfast
w. thoroughgoing
x. quick-change
y. lukewarm
z. law-abiding
aa. far-reaching
bb. homemade

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cc. clean-cut
dd. fighter-bomber
ee. earthenware
ff. driver's seat
gg. baking powder
hh. drip-coffee
ii. wisecrack
jj. snowplow

7. The following words are compounds which also include derivational affixes. Analyze the words, identifying the roots and their parts of speech, as well all the affixes and their function as nominalizer, verbalizer, adjectivalizer, or adverbializer.

Example: housekeeper

house (root - noun) + keep (root - verb) + -er (nominalizer)

a. flightworthiness
b. chatterbox
c. owner-occupied
d. freedom-loving
e. handicraft
f. broken-hearted
g. safety-tested
h. worldly-wise
i. antiaircraft
j. machine-readable
k. chartered accountant

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8. Identify the process of word formation responsible for each of the following words. Try to determine the process before you consult a dictionary, though it may be necessary for you to do so.

a. curio
b. (to) laze
c. (to) network
d. (to) cohere
e. (a) sitcom
f. (the) muppets
g. (a) what-not
h. margarine
i. diesel
j. (to) make up
k. (to) total
l. (the) hereafter
m. amphetamine
n. (a) construct
o. (the) chunnel
p. gestimate
q. canary
r. brain-gain
s. psycho
t. walkie-talkie

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9. The words in column A have been created from the corresponding words in column B. Indicate the word formation process responsible for the creation of each word in column A.

	Column A	**Column B**
(a)	Stagflation	stagnation + inflation
(b)	Nostril	nosu + thyrl 'hole' (in Old English)
(c)	Bookie	bookmaker
(d)	Van	caravan
(e)	Amerindian	American Indian
(f)	CD	compact disc
(g)	RAM	random access memory
(h)	Televise	television
(i)	Xerox	xeroxography
(j)	Telethon	television + marathon
(k)	sci-fi	science fiction
(l)	Elect	election
(m)	Deli	delicatessen
(n)	Scuba	self-contained underwater breathing apparatus
(o)	Scavenge	scavenger
(p)	Hazmat	hazardous material

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